

Experiment No. 2: Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface

1. Aim

To configure and examine the Zoho Creator environment by building a Corporate Asset Maintenance application, creating data-entry forms and reports, viewing a dashboard, and understanding how the Develop, Deploy and Manage areas support application development and administration.

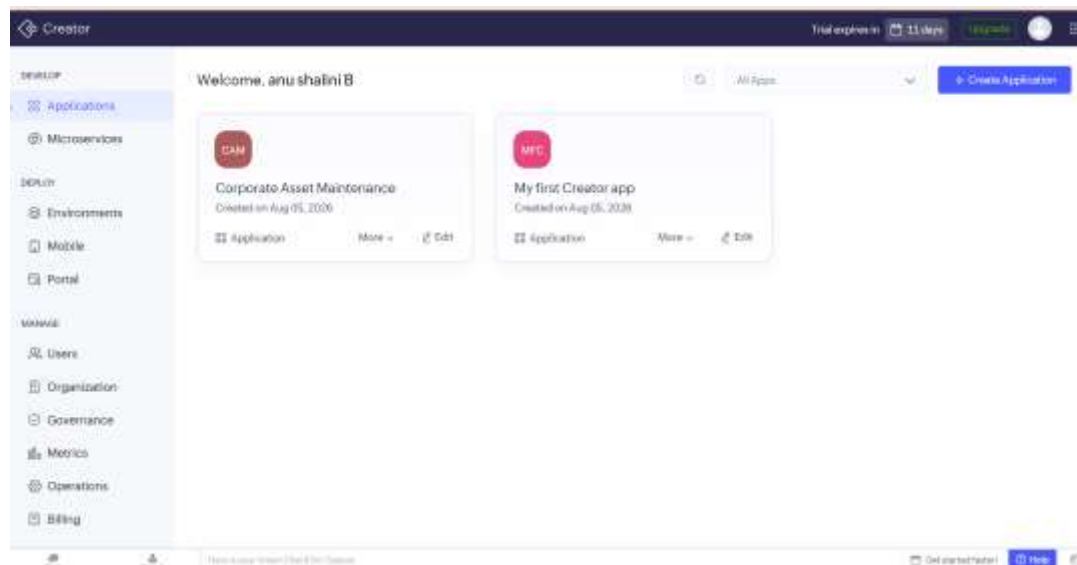
2. Setting up Zoho Creator

A Zoho Creator application titled Corporate Asset Maintenance was configured to organize information about company equipment, service requests and repair activities.

The application was structured with the following forms:

1. Department – Captures department information including Department ID, department name, responsible head and workplace location.
2. Asset Details – Records equipment information such as Asset ID, asset name, category, purchase amount and current status.
3. Technician – Maintains technician profiles including identification, name, technical area, experience and availability.
4. Maintenance Request – Stores service requests raised when an organizational asset needs inspection or repair.
5. Maintenance Approvals – Records the approval decision for maintenance work according to the expected expenditure.
6. Repair Progress – Follows the work carried out by technicians until the requested repair is completed.

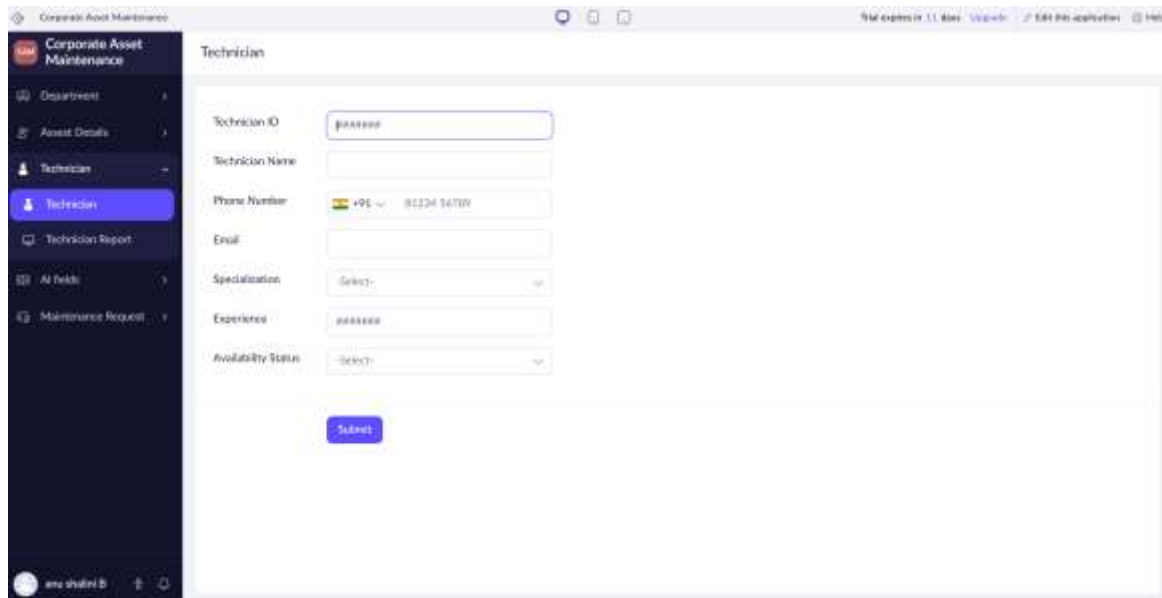
Sample Application: Corporate Asset Maintenance



A. Creating Form

A form in Zoho Creator acts as the data-entry layer of an application. It provides structured fields through which users submit information that is stored for later processing and reporting.

For this application, the Department and Technician forms demonstrate how information can be collected in a consistent format. The Technician form, for example, includes fields for the technician's name, contact number, email, specialization, experience and current availability.

The screenshot displays the 'Corporate Asset Maintenance' application interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with a menu containing 'Department', 'Asset Details', 'Technician', 'Technician Report', 'All Fields', and 'Maintenance Request'. The 'Technician' option is highlighted. The main area shows the 'Technician' form with the following fields: 'Technician ID' (text input with a masked value), 'Technician Name' (text input), 'Phone Number' (text input with a country code dropdown set to '+96' and a masked number), 'Email' (text input), 'Specialization' (dropdown menu), 'Experience' (text input with a masked value), and 'Availability Status' (dropdown menu). A blue 'Submit' button is located at the bottom of the form. The top of the application window shows the title 'Corporate Asset Maintenance' and a status bar indicating 'Not expires in 11 days'.

Explanation:

The form separates technician details into individual fields so that entries remain organized and reusable. After submission, the information becomes part of the application's stored records and can be displayed in corresponding reports.

B. Creating Report

A report presents records collected through a form in a structured and searchable view. It allows users to review stored information without opening each individual form entry.

In the Corporate Asset Maintenance application, the Asset Details Report can be used to review Asset ID, asset name, category, serial number, purchase date, warranty expiry date and purchase cost.

department_id	Department name	Department head	Department location
2	adn	john	madurai
1	cae	viji	chennai

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Explanation:

The report gathers the submitted asset records into a single view. This makes it easier to inspect equipment information, compare entries, locate a particular asset and maintain an up-to-date inventory.

C.Creating Dashboard

A dashboard presents important application information in a compact visual layout. It can combine summary panels and other visual components so that users can understand the current state of operations quickly.

The Corporate Asset Dashboard can summarize indicators such as:

- Total Assets
- Total Maintenance Requests
- Pending Approvals
- Completed Repairs

Explanation:

The dashboard gives management a quick operational view of asset and maintenance activity. Its displayed values are linked to application data and can change as records are added or updated.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface:

A.Develop

1. The Develop area is the main workspace for designing and customizing a Zoho Creator application.
2. It provides tools for building forms, reports, pages, workflows and dashboards according to application requirements.
3. Deluge scripting can be used to implement validation, automation and application-specific logic.

B.Deploy

1. The Deploy area is used to publish the completed application for intended users.
2. Applications can be made accessible through supported web and mobile experiences.

3. Access control can be configured so that users receive permissions appropriate to their assigned roles.

C.Manage

1. The Manage area supports administration and continued maintenance of the application.
2. It provides controls for users, permissions, stored data, application settings and integrations.
3. Administrators can review the application configuration and make changes when operational requirements evolve.

Result

Thus, the Corporate Asset Maintenance application was configured and explored successfully in Zoho Creator. The exercise demonstrated the creation of forms and reports, the use of a dashboard for summary information, and the purpose of the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections in the platform.